STAFF GUIDE · AJG (ASSEMBLYMEMBER JESSE GABRIEL) PRESS COVERAGE

Updating the tracker with the Update station

How to find new stories about Jesse Gabriel and save them into the PC tracker, from start to finish.

How the job works

New stories reach the tracker in a loop between your PC and a page on claude.ai called the **Update station**. The PC tells the station what the tracker already has; the station searches for what is new and hands back one zip file; the PC checks it and saves it. The station has its own Step 1, Step 2 and Step 3; this guide uses those names, and names the PC parts by where they are.

Part	Where	What happens	Page
Make the “for Update” file	PC tracker	A small file listing the stories the tracker already has.	3
Step 1: load the file	Update station	The station now knows what not to find again, and from which date to search.	4
Step 2: Update	Update station	Searches the web for new stories. About 25 minutes.	6
Also: add PDFs (optional)	Update station	NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, for stories the web search can’t reach. (For NewsBank, see the separate NewsBank Download Guide.)	8
Step 3: download the update folder	Update station	One .zip file with everything found.	9
Bring in update and Save	PC tracker	The tracker shows what it would change; you press Save.	10
Make refresh files	PC tracker	So your colleagues’ copies match yours.	14

Words used in this guide

Word	What it means
Claude	The AI assistant (made by Anthropic) that reads each search result, keeps the real stories and rates them.
TinyFish	The web-search service the station uses to find new stories.

Word	What it means
“for Update” file	A small file the PC tracker makes that lists the stories it already has. It holds no article text.
Update folder	The .zip file the station gives you. (A .zip is one file that holds many files.)
Refresh file	A .zip the keeper makes after a save, so colleagues’ copies match.
Keeper	The one person who saves updates (currently Sammy). Some program messages name Sammy; they mean the keeper.
Fingerprint	A short code worked out from the workbook’s exact contents, like `41315fe0`. It changes whenever the workbook changes.

BEFORE YOU START

Before you start

1. **Use the keeper copy** of the PC tracker. Only the keeper saves updates. (The companion guide, *Using the AJG Press Tracker*, explains keeper and reader copies.)
2. **Close Excel** if the workbook is open.
3. **Have the Update station link ready:**

   Open the Update station

   https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL
4. **The first time, allow Claude and TinyFish for the station page.** Claude: in the page’s Permissions menu, allow it, including sending pictures (it reads newspaper pages). TinyFish: it must be connected in claude.ai (Settings, Connectors) and allowed for the page.

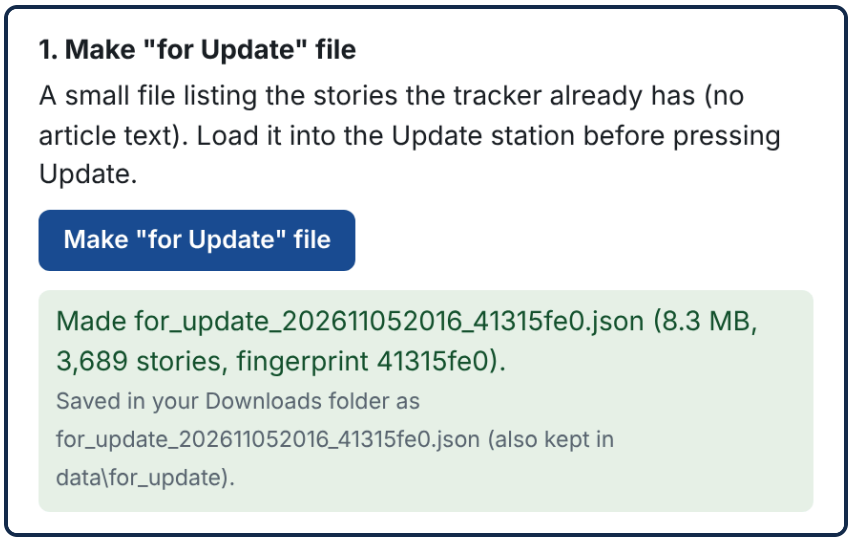
Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC

The Update station never changes your workbook. It only makes a zip file. The PC tracker shows you everything in the zip before it saves, and backs up the workbook first.

ON THE PC

Make the “for Update” file

1. Start the tracker (double-click `Start Tracker.cmd`).
2. Click **Tracker files** at the top right.
3. Under **1. Make “for Update” file**, click the button. It takes about a minute.
4. The file downloads to your Downloads folder, named like `for_update_202611052016_41315fe0.json`: the date and time it was made, then the workbook’s fingerprint.



The file was made and downloaded.

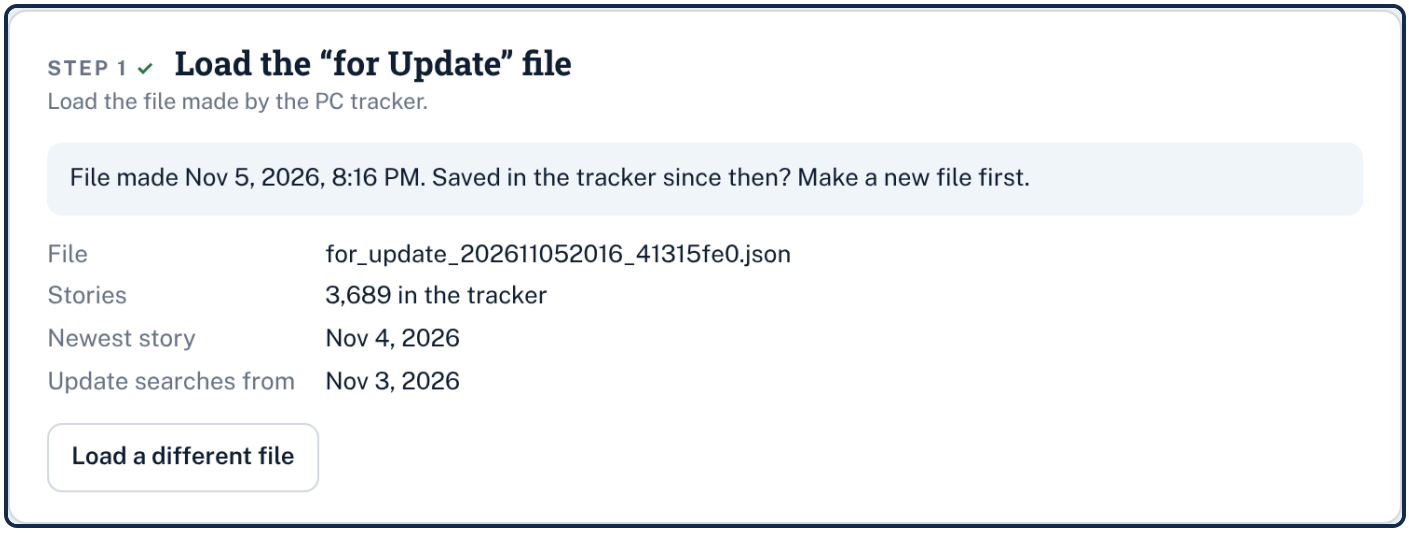
MAKE A NEW ONE AFTER EVERY SAVE

The file lists the stories the tracker has right now. A file made before a save doesn’t know about the stories that save added, so the station would find them again. The file is not stored online.

IN THE STATION · STEP 1

Open the station and load the file

1. Open the Update station in your browser: https://claude.ai/artifact/5uGsM8yQMphjAQbKhvc5SL. If it asks you to sign in, sign in to claude.ai with the office account (ask the keeper).
2. In **Step 1**, drop the “for Update” file on the dashed box, or click the box and choose the file from Downloads.
3. Check what the station read from it: the file name, the number of stories, the **Newest story**, and **Update searches from**. The search starts the day before the newest story, so there is no date to pick.



Step 1 after loading. The gray line says when the file was made; if you saved in the tracker since then, make a new file first.

The top of the station has two buttons. **How it works** opens the station’s own short explanation of every part. **Update database** starts the search, the same as the button in Step 2.



The top of the station: 1 How it works, 2 Update database.

IN THE STATION

How it works

How it works Close

What this page does

It finds new stories about Jesse Gabriel and packs them into one zip, the update folder. You bring that zip into the PC tracker (Tracker files, Bring in update). The PC tracker shows you everything before it saves. This page never changes your workbook.

Step 1: the “for Update” file

Make it on the PC (Tracker files, Make “for Update” file) and load it here. It lists the stories the tracker already has, so nothing is found twice. It holds no article text and is not stored online.

Make a new one after every save. A file made before a save does not know about the stories that save added, and finds them again.

Step 2: Update

Update searches the web from the day before the newest story in the tracker up to today. There is no date to pick. It takes about 25 minutes; keep this tab open.

Claude reads every result and keeps only real stories that name Assemblymember Gabriel. It leaves out press releases, social posts, YouTube, blogs, listing pages and other people named Gabriel. It fills in each story’s issue, bills, format, reach and tone.

A story the tracker already has is left out, even when the tracker’s copy came from NewsBank and has no web link. A copy of a known story at another outlet is added as a reprint. A row with no date takes the date in its web address when it has one.

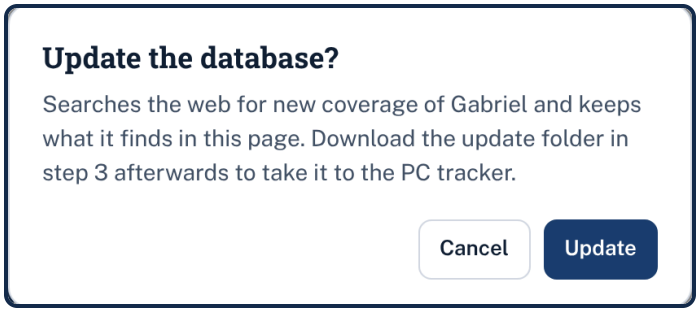
Stories not in English get an English headline, and their whole story is translated into English when you download the folder.

The top of the How it works window. It goes on to cover NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs, downloading, Automatic mode (page 8) and what to do if something is blocked. Close returns to the page.

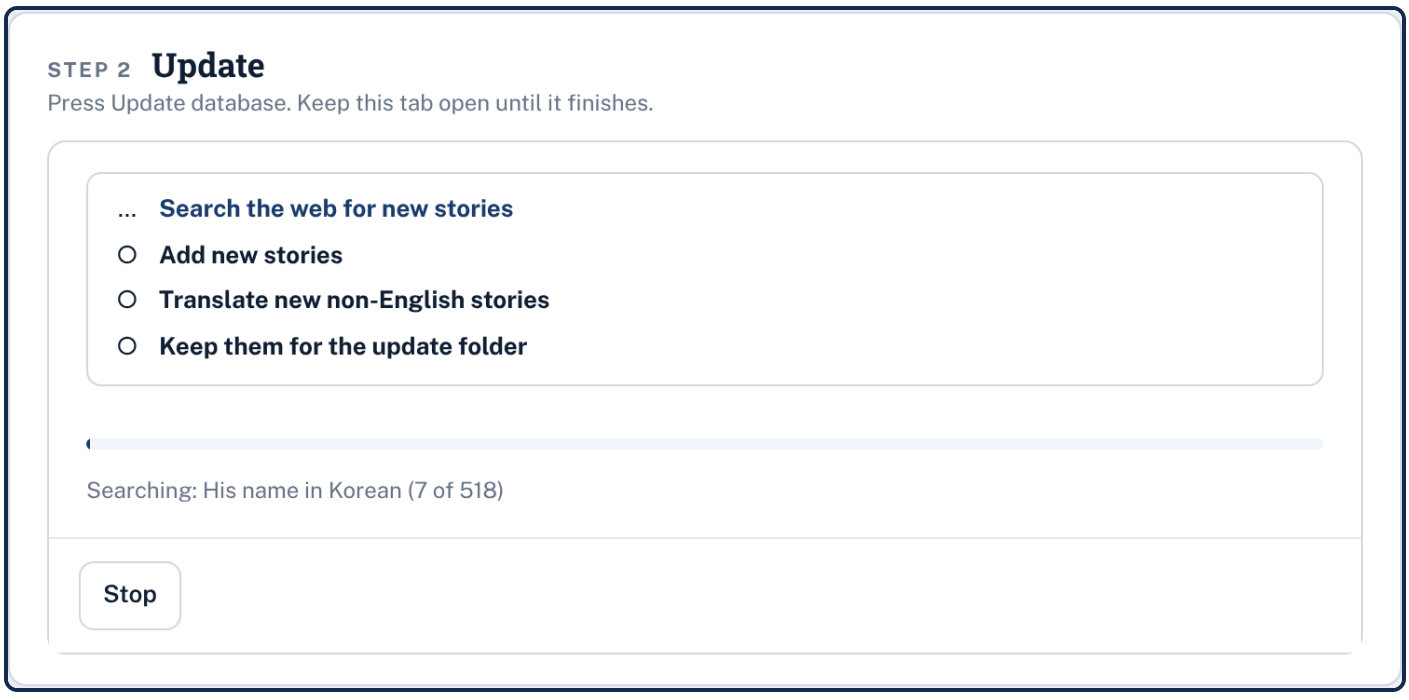
IN THE STATION · STEP 2

Press Update database

1. In **Step 2: Update**, press **Update database**. A box asks you to confirm; press **Update**.
2. **Keep the tab open** and in front until it finishes. It takes about 25 minutes. Browsers slow down tabs in the background, which can stall the run. You can use other programs; just don't close the tab.
3. Watch the checklist. Each line gets a check mark when it is done: search the web, add new stories, translate non-English stories, keep them for the update folder. While it runs, a **Stop** button under the checklist ends the run early.

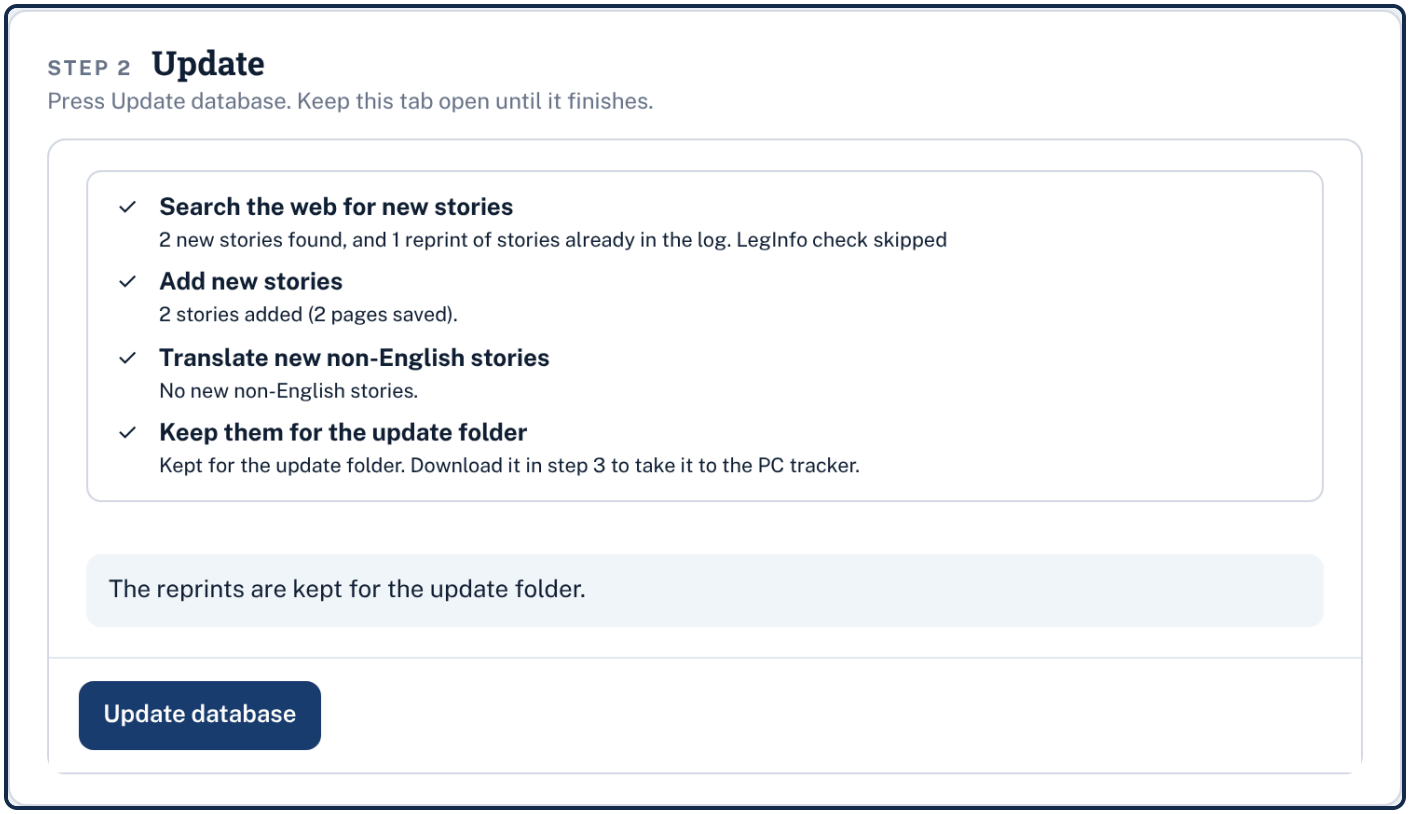


The confirm box.



While it runs: the line in blue is the one being worked on. Stop ends the run early.

When the run is done



A finished run (a test run with made-up stories). Each line says what it found. (LegInfo, the Legislature's bill website, is checked for new bills; a test run skips it.)

What the search does for you

- Claude, the AI, reads every result and keeps only real news stories that name Assemblymember Gabriel. It leaves out press releases, social posts, YouTube, blogs, listing pages and other people named Gabriel.
- It fills in each story's issue, bills, format, reach and tone.
- A story the tracker already has is left out. A copy of a known story at another outlet is added as a **reprint** of it.
- Stories not in English get an English headline. The whole story is translated into English when you download the folder.

IF THE RUN ENDS EARLY

A red note says so. It does not mean "nothing new". Press Update database again, or download what it found and run it again another time.

IN THE STATION · OPTIONAL

Add NewsBank and ProQuest PDFs

About 1 in 6 stories (print, wire stories, paywalled papers) can't be found on the web. About once a month, and soon after big events like the budget vote, add them from NewsBank. ProQuest PDFs work the same way in their own box.

1. **Download the PDFs** by following the **NewsBank Download Guide** (a separate printed guide): the State Library sign-in, the saved search, Sort by Oldest, and one PDF per page of results with APA citations. It says to start one week before the newest story in the tracker; the station shows that date in Step 1 as **Newest story**.
2. **Drop the PDFs** on the box **Add NewsBank PDFs and newspaper pages** (or **Add ProQuest PDFs**). You can drop many at once. A PDF can hold any number of stories.
3. With **Automatic mode** on (in Step 3 on the page; on by default), they are added by themselves. If it is off, check the list and press **Add to the update**.



The NewsBank box. It also takes a picture or PDF of any newspaper page. "Add to the update" wakes up once a PDF is dropped. The ProQuest box below it looks the same.

- The station splits each NewsBank PDF into one PDF per story and skips stories the tracker already has.
- A NewsBank "Full Page" is a picture of a newspaper page. Claude reads it and adds the article about him to the right story, or as a new story. A page it can't place goes to the workbook's **Unlinked print pages** tab.
- If a run is going, the PDFs wait for it to finish.

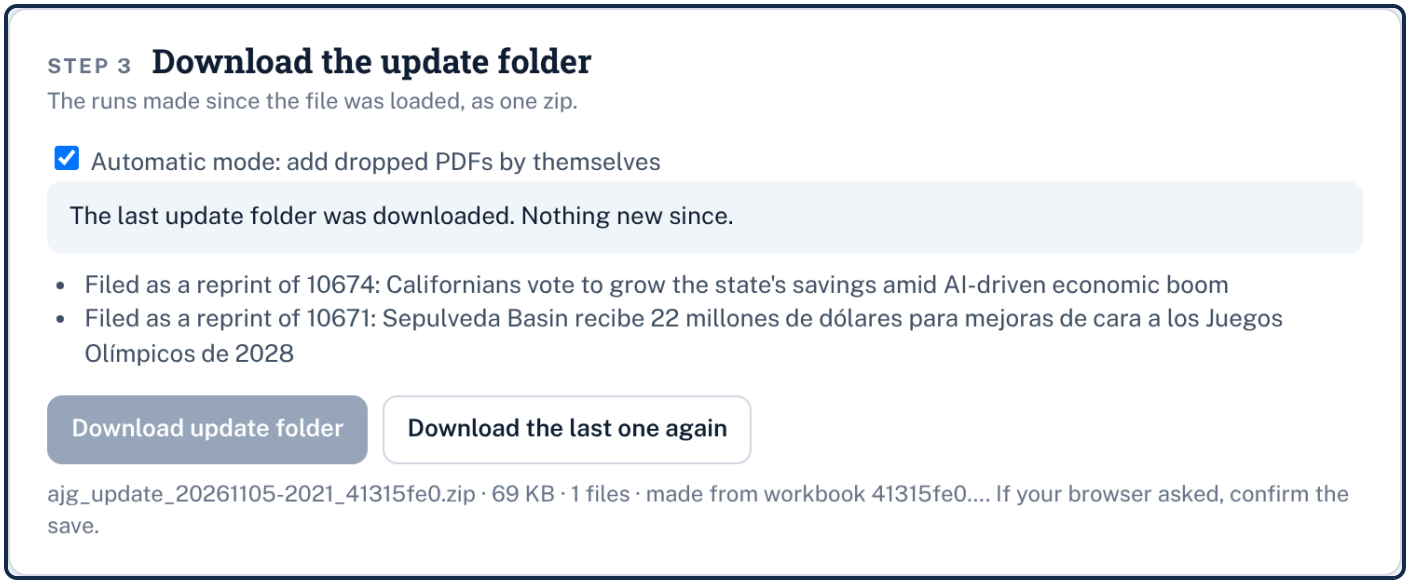
IN THE STATION · STEP 3

Download the update folder

1. When the run (and any PDFs) are done, **Step 3** says what is ready, for example “Ready: 1 run: 8 new stories, 16 reprints”. Lines such as “Filed as a reprint of 10674: …” name finds the station filed under a story the tracker already has (10674 is that story’s Article ID).
2. Press **Download update folder**. It saves one .zip to your Downloads folder, named like `ajg_update_20261105-2021_41315fe0.zip` (the date and time, then the workbook’s fingerprint). If your browser asks, confirm the save.
3. If you add more after downloading, download again. The new folder has everything and replaces the old one; its name ends in `_v2`. Bring in only the newest one.
4. **Don’t unzip it.** The PC tracker takes the .zip file itself.



Ready to download.

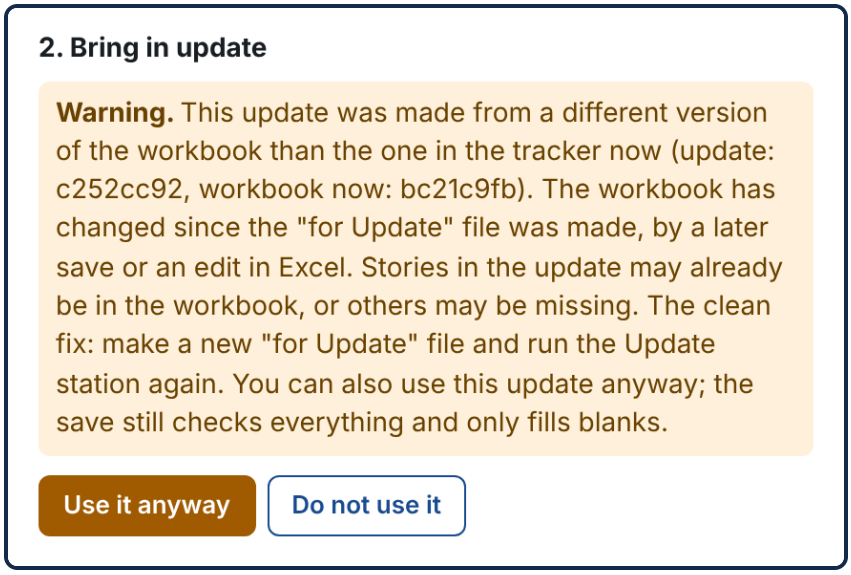


Downloaded. “Download the last one again” is there if the file went missing.

ON THE PC

Bring in the update

1. Close Excel. In the tracker, click **Tracker files**.
2. Drop the update zip on the dashed box under **2. Bring in update**, or click **choose a file**.
3. Wait. The tracker checks the update. Nothing is saved yet. It can take a few minutes.
4. **If a yellow warning appears**, the workbook changed after you made the “for Update” file. Press **Use it anyway** to go on to the preview (the save still checks everything and only fills blanks), or **Do not use it** to stop. The clean fix is a new “for Update” file and a new station run.
5. Read the preview (next page), then press **Save** at its end, or **Do not use this update**.



The warning for an update made from an older workbook: Use it anyway, or Do not use it.

Read the preview

2. Bring in update

If you press Save: 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

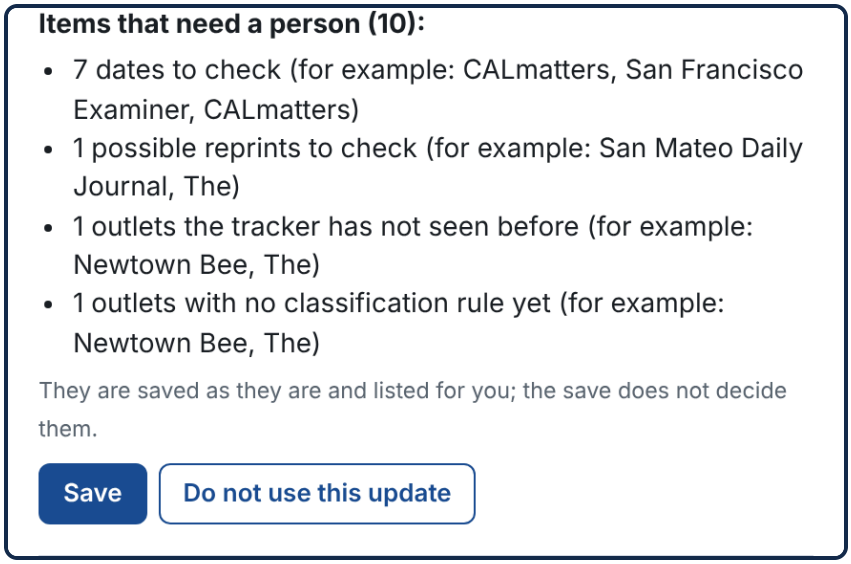
You chose to use an update made from an older workbook. The save still runs all its checks.

- Your edits made in this tracker, saved together with it: 1 story removed (s01888)
- 21 rows added to the Coverage tab
- 10 rows added to the Originals tab
- 1 row added to the Removed tab
- 2 rows added to the Unlinked print pages tab
- 4 reprint counts updated
- 2 cells of removed stories' rows moved to the Removed tab
- 2 press-release cells recalculated
- 25 saved pages added to the library
- 1 file of removed stories moved aside (not deleted)

The top of the preview: what Save would do. (A long list of renamed files under it is left out here.)

- **The bold line** sums up what Save would do: rows added, cells filled, reprints, and your own waiting edits.
- The tracker compares the article texts to make the final call on what is a reprint, and gives the new files their final numbers. The preview lists every change.
- “Conflicts left for Sammy” means cells where the update and the workbook disagree; the save kept the workbook’s value and left them for the keeper.

Items that need a person, then Save



The end of the preview: items that need a person, then Save.

Items that need a person are things the save does not decide for you. **The save writes them as they are** and lists them. Each line names the kind of item, with examples:

Item	What it means
Cells where the update disagrees with the workbook	The update had a different value; the workbook kept its own.
Dates to check	The save could not confirm the story's date. Check it against the story.
Possible reprints to check	The story may be a copy of one the tracker already has.
Outlets not seen before / with no classification rule	A new outlet; its reach and type may need setting.
Other kinds	The line says in plain words what it is, for example stories where it is unclear they are about the Assemblymember.

Nothing needs doing before you press Save. Afterwards, check those rows in the workbook. If a filled value is wrong, the keeper fixes it in Excel and then uses Tracker files, Repairs, "Accept the workbook as it is now".

1. Press **Save**, or **Do not use this update** to drop it.
2. Keep the black window open. The tracker backs up the workbook, writes, then reloads the page by itself.

ON THE PC, CONTINUED

After the save

2. Bring in update

Saved. 21 rows added, 51 cells filled, 1 rows of 1 removed stories moved to the Removed tab, 1 finds skipped (California Files, listing pages, other Gabriels or Gabriel only outside the article), 1 finds written as reprints (same text as another story), 7 dates to check (see review).

- Backup of the old workbook: AJG Coverage - NewsBank BACKUP before run run-mw3o2qv2rzz 2026-11-05 1213.xlsx

After Save: the result and the backup it made.

- 0 file name(s) were as the station named them.
- 1 edit saved and set aside in the tracker (db_applied\edits, not deleted)
- New workbook fingerprint: 41315fe0
- The tracker page was rebuilt with the new stories
- 10 items are listed for a person to look at (see the run notes)

Reloading the tracker...

The end of the result: the new workbook fingerprint. (“db_applied\edits” is a folder inside data; you never need to open it.)

The new stories are now in the tracker. The line at the top of the page says “Last updated” with today’s date, and the Update log in Manage lists the update with everything it added.

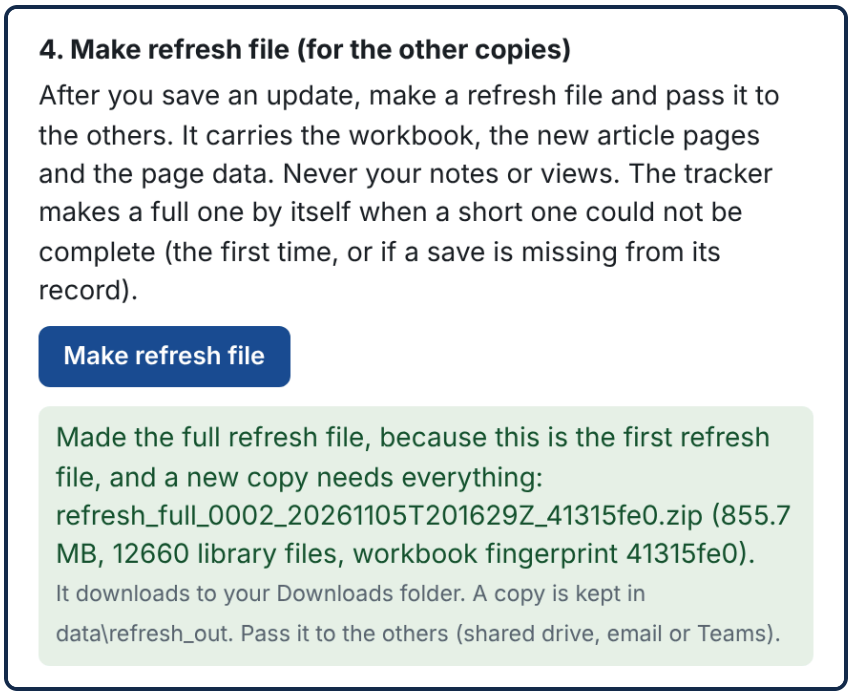
NEXT TIME, A NEW “FOR UPDATE” FILE

The save changed the workbook. Before the next station run, make a new “for Update” file.

ON THE PC

Make refresh files for colleagues

1. In **Tracker files**, under **4. Make refresh file**, click **Make refresh file**.
2. It downloads to your Downloads folder.
3. Pass it on by the **shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick**. Don’t use email or Teams: the first refresh file carries the whole library and is hundreds of MB; later ones are smaller.
4. Each colleague closes Excel, opens their own tracker, clicks **Tracker files**, and drops the file on **Bring in refresh file**. Their notes and saved views stay as they are.



The refresh file was made: 855.7 MB, because it was the first one. (The program’s own message also mentions email and Teams; for a file this size use the shared drive, OneDrive or a USB stick.)

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Problems and fixes

What you see	What to do
The station page asks you to sign in	Sign in to claude.ai with the office account; the keeper has it.
“Claude is not allowed on this page”	Allow Claude for the station page in the Permissions menu, including sending pictures, then reload the page.
The search finds nothing or stops at once	TinyFish must be connected in claude.ai (Settings, Connectors) and allowed for the station page.
“File made … Saved in the tracker since then? Make a new file first.”	If you saved in the tracker after making the file, make a new “for Update” file and load that one.
A red note says the run ended early	It does not mean nothing new. Run Update database again.
You closed the station tab during a run	The run stops. Load the “for Update” file again and press Update database again.
You added PDFs after downloading	Download again. Bring in only the newest zip (the one ending _v2, _v3 …).
The PC warns the update was made from a different workbook	Make a new “for Update” file and run the station again, or press Use it anyway.
The PC says the update was already saved	You brought in a zip that was saved before. Nothing is added twice. Use the newest zip, or make a new “for Update” file and run again.
Save is grayed out	Close Excel, and wait for any other save to finish. If the workbook was changed in Excel, use Repairs, “Accept the workbook as it is now”.
“That is not a .zip file”	Drop the .zip itself, not an unzipped folder.

CHEAT SHEET

Start to finish

On the PC

1. Tracker files → **Make “for Update” file** (p. 3).
2. When the zip is downloaded: Tracker files → **Bring in update** → drop the zip (p. 10).
3. Read the preview and the items that need a person → **Save**.
4. **Make refresh file** → shared drive, OneDrive or USB (p. 14).

In the Update station (its Steps 1–3)

1. Step 1: drop the “for Update” file; check **Update searches from** (p. 4).
2. Step 2: **Update database** → Update. Keep the tab open, about 25 minutes (p. 6).
3. Also, optional: drop NewsBank / ProQuest PDFs (p. 8).
4. Step 3: **Download update folder** (p. 9).

REMEMBER

Make a new “for Update” file after every save. Bring in only the newest zip. Nothing is saved until you press Save on the PC.